



MINI CEREMONIES ARE OPTIONAL.

A MINI CEREMONY CAN BE A SYMBOLIC
ACT OR THE START OF A TRADITION.

THEY'RE ALSO AN OPPORTUNITY
TO GIVE GUESTS SPECIAL ROLES.

YOU CAN EVEN MAKE UP YOUR
OWN MINI CEREMONIES IF
INSPIRED BY ONE YOU READ HERE.

CHECK 'EM OUT & SEE IF THERE
ARE ANY YOU WANT TO INCLUDE!

MINI CEREMONIES



After the welcome, your rings are silently passed in a pouch or small box from guest to guest as the ceremony continues. As the rings are passed, each guest takes a moment to say a silent blessing, prayer or positive thought when the rings come to them. When it's time for the ring exchange, I declare "Who has the rings!", the person who has them stands up and says, "I do!" and we retrieve them. We designate someone from your wedding party to start the ring pass by handing the rings to a guest in the front row, and to retrieve the rings when it's time. I will coach that person on how to do this.

Items for you to bring

A pouch or box to keep the rings secure.

RING BLESSING



After vows, a designated person brings up a wooden box with a bottle of wine in it, or it's on a table or rock nearby. You share vows, then you put your vow cards in the box and seal the box. This starts a tradition in your marriage – every anniversary, you open the box, drink the wine and re-read your vows to one another, then put your vows and a new bottle of wine back in the box to do it again the next year. You can also put love letters in the box. Or make it a five or ten-year time capsule rather than a yearly tradition. If you don't like wine, you can do whiskey, tequila, something non-alcoholic or whatever you like. **Guest Participation:** Someone special can bring the box up if you want a guest to participate.

Items for you to bring

A bottle of wine and wooden box to put it in – if it has a closure or clasp, that's ideal. Vow cards.

Optional sealed love letters.

WINE BOX



An old Celtic tradition where the term “tie the knot” originated. Right before vows, you hold hands so that six ribbons can be laid over them, each ribbon representing a quality that is important to the two of you for your marriage, like “honesty”, “adventure”, “connection” etc. The ribbons are tied in a knot around your hands, then you share vows. Then the knot is removed and you can keep it as a reminder of the moment you shared vows on your wedding day. **Guest Participation:** Someone special can bring up the ribbons/cloth and/or guests can lay the ribbons over your hands if you want guest participation.

Items for you to bring

Six ribbons, one for each quality.
Make sure ribbons are each at least four feet in length for easy tying.

HAND FASTING



After vows, you are guided to each give one red rose to the other. Right before that, the ceremony describes how the red rose historically represents true love, and that this is an additional gift that you give to one another in this moment of commitment, and that this is also the start of a tradition in your marriage – you can have a special place for roses in your home and place roses there when you want to celebrate each other or when you are feeling disconnected and want to remember the core nature of your love. The roses bring you back to the moment of commitment on your wedding day. **Guest Participation:** If you want guest participation, someone special can bring the roses up when it's time to exchange.

Items for you to bring

Two single red roses, thorn-free.
If you prefer a different color, go for it!

ROSE EXCHANGE



After vows, you are each guided to pour a color of sand into a vase, thus the two sand colors mix to become one to represent your joined lives. You can also have a third sand color in its own vase, and that color is poured as a symbol that something of a divine nature (whatever your name for it) is with you in your relationship. The sand art becomes a symbol of union in your home. **Guest**

Participation: A great opportunity for children or parents to pour a color of sand too.

Items for you to bring

Different colors of sand. Small vase for each color. One larger vase to pour the colors into. Ideal vases are larger on the bottom so they stand sturdily and don't blow over in wind. Table to do sand ceremony on.

SAND CEREMONY



Buy a small tree or seedling, plant it into a small pot *before* the ceremony, then during the ceremony add into the pot two different containers of soil – one from each of your home towns, or from places that are important to each of you. Or simply use the same soil – each of you putting some of the soil into the pot. Then during the ceremony add water for good measure. When home, the tree can be planted in the ground or kept inside to symbolize your union and wedding day. **Guest Participation:** A great opportunity for children, parents or others to plant with you.

Items for you to bring

Seeds or VERY small seedling tree, already planted in a small pot. Two containers of soil to add. Container with water to pour.

Table to put all items on.

TREE PLANTING



Unity Candles are best suited for indoor ceremonies. After vows you each use a separate, already-lit taper candle to light a larger main candle, symbolizing joining your two lives. The main candle becomes a symbol of your union in your home to light whenever you like. **Guest Participation:** Children, parents or other special people can also join in lighting with you, or light a special family candle.

Items for you to bring

Small taper candles & holders. One main candle and holder. Lighter or matches.

UNITY CANDLE